

Mingpu Xiao

Department of Political Science, University of California, San Diego

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EDUCATION

University of California, San Diego

Expected June 2027

Ph.D. in Political Science

Dissertation: *The Political Logic of State-Owned Enterprises: Legitimacy, State Capacity, and Elite Power-Sharing*

Advisors: Margaret E. Roberts, Victor Shih

Committee: J. Lawrence Broz, Megumi Naoi, Francisco Garfias

University of California, San Diego

2020

Master of International Affairs (International Economics track), School of Global Policy and Strategy

Nanjing University

2018

M.A. in Political Theory, School of Government

Certificate in Chinese and American Studies, Hopkins–Nanjing Center for Chinese and American Studies (2017)

Beijing Institute of Technology

2015

B.A. in Economics

Research Interests

Political economy; political communication and public opinion; Chinese politics; computational political science; causal inference; survey experiments

Publications

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

- Xiao, Mingpu, and Tangbiao Xiao. 2017. “Determinants of Public Attitudes toward Political Order: Evidence from a Sample Survey in Province C, China” (in Chinese). *Administrative Tribune* 24(5). (CSSCI)

Book Chapters

- Xiao, Mingpu, and Tangbiao Xiao. “The Evolution, Typology, and Characteristics of Chinese Citizens’ Economic Values” (in Chinese). In *Report on Social Governance in the New Era*, edited by Wenfang Tang, Jie Chen, and Tangbiao Xiao. Guangzhou: Sun Yat-sen University Press. (Forthcoming 2026)

Working Papers

- “Legitimizing State Capitalism: Nationalism and Public Support for State Ownership.” (Job Market Paper; under review)
- “International Origins of Populism: WTO and U.S. Presidential Elections” (with Marc-Andreas Muendler, T. Renee Bowen, and J. Lawrence Broz; co-first author with Marc-Andreas Muendler).
- “Public Conceptions of Political Order: Concept, Measurement, and Typology” (with Tangbiao Xiao; in Chinese).

Conference Presentations

“Socialism with Chinese Characteristics 2.0: How Nationalism Drives Public Support for State-Owned Economy”

- Chinese Politics Mini-Conference, American Political Science Association (APSA) Annual Meeting, Boston, September 2026. (Accepted)
- Young Scholars Conference, Fudan–UC Center on Contemporary China, San Diego, May 2026.
- Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA) Annual Conference, Chicago, April 2026.

Grants, Fellowships, and Awards

2026	Yankelovich Center Research Grant, UC San Diego (\$3,500)
2024–2025	Dean’s Research and Travel Grant, UC San Diego (\$1,000)
2020	Richard Covington Best Paper Award, School of Global Policy and Strategy, UC San Diego
2019	Dean’s Fellowship, School of Global Policy and Strategy, UC San Diego
2016–2018	First-Class Graduate Fellowship, Nanjing University
2017	National Scholarship, Ministry of Education of China
2017	Huang Chengfeng Research Fellow, Hopkins–Nanjing Center for Chinese and American Studies
2017	Student Delegate, Chicago Forum on Global Cities

Research Experience

Research Assistant 2022 – Present

21st Century China Center, UC San Diego

- *China from the Ground Up Survey*: designed, coordinated, and fielded online surveys of Chinese citizens’ political attitudes; analyzed and visualized survey data and disseminated findings to academic and public audiences.
- Collected and analyzed data on local government debt in China.
- Maintained a large-scale corpus of Chinese newspapers.

Research Associate 2020 – 2021

Center for Commerce and Diplomacy, UC San Diego

- Applied causal inference and machine learning methods to analyze the impact of WTO Appellate Body rulings on U.S. presidential elections, resulting in the working paper “International Origins of Populism: WTO and U.S. Presidential Elections.”

Robinson Summer Research Fellow Summer 2019

School of Global Policy and Strategy, UC San Diego

- Analyzed data from eight survey experiments testing the causal effects of international election observation and foreign meddling on trust in elections; findings were incorporated into the book *Monitors and Meddlers: How Foreign Actors Influence Local Trust in Elections* (by Sarah S. Bush and Lauren Prather).

Research Assistant

2015 – 2018

Center for Public Affairs and Local Governance, Nanjing University

- *Chinese Citizens' Political Values Survey* (2015–2018): contributed to questionnaire design and data collection; applied model-based statistical inference to measure and predict citizens' political values along dimensions such as democracy, order, the rule of law, and civil liberties (Jiangsu Province).
- *Asian Barometer Survey* (2015): conducted fieldwork in urban and rural Anhui Province as a survey team supervisor; organized GIS-based household sampling and completed questionnaire data collection.
- *Local Governance and Reform* (2016–2018): contributed to survey design and data collection and interviewed local government officials; combined quantitative analysis with case studies to examine the relationships among urbanization, local administrative reform, public attitudes, and political participation (Pukou District, Nanjing).
- *Grassroots Elections and Democracy in Rural China* (2012, 2015): conducted fieldwork in rural Jiangxi Province, observing village committee elections, interviewing village cadres and villagers, and collecting survey data; wrote research reports analyzing the relationships among lineage networks, social capital, electoral participation, and public goods provision.

Teaching Experience

- *Research Methods in Political Science* (undergraduate), Teaching Assistant and Discussion Section Leader, UC San Diego, Fall 2025 and Spring 2025.
- *Introduction to Comparative Politics* (undergraduate), Teaching Assistant and Discussion Section Leader, UC San Diego, Winter 2025, Fall 2024, and Fall 2023.
- *Applied Data Analysis for Political Science* (undergraduate), Teaching Assistant, UC San Diego, Summer 2023.
- *Policy Responses to Global Issues* (graduate), Teaching Assistant, UC San Diego, Fall 2021.

Skills

- **Research methods:** computational text analysis; causal inference with observational data; randomized experimental design (field and survey experiments); measurement models; machine learning and large language models (fine-tuning BERT-family models, LoRA fine-tuning of open-source LLMs, API-based workflows)
- **Programming and data:** R, Python, SQL (MySQL), L^AT_EX; model training and inference in GPU environments
- **Languages:** Chinese (native); English (fluent)

References

Margaret E. Roberts (Advisor)
Professor, Department of Political Science
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J. Lawrence Broz (Committee Member)
Professor, Department of Political Science
University of California, San Diego
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Victor Shih (Advisor)
Professor, School of Global Policy and Strategy
University of California, San Diego
vcshih@ucsd.edu

Fengyang Zhang (M.A. Advisor)
Changjiang Scholar Distinguished Professor
School of Government, Nanjing University
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